

COMMODE Originally a name for a wire framework covered with *silk* or *lace* to form a tall headdress for women, and then the term for the headdress itself; later commodes had long *lappets* that hung down to the shoulders or were pinned up.

17TH–18TH CENTURY: SEE PP.133, 139

CONVERSE “CHUCK TAYLOR”

ALL STAR® A brand of basketball boots with a high top, canvas upper, and rubber sole, named “All Star” after the logo, and “Chuck Taylor” after 1920s basketball star Chuck Taylor, an ambassador for the brand; now globally popular, especially with young men and women.

1917 ▷

COPE A full cloak cut as a semicircle and worn by clerics of various Christian churches.

MEDIEVAL ▷: SEE P.57

CORDED SILK Heavy *silk* with raised ribs on the surface; see also *Rep*.

19TH CENTURY

CORDOVAN Fine Spanish leather, originally made from horse hide, used for gloves and shoes.

MEDIEVAL ▷

CORDUROY A *cotton* fabric with a soft *pile* forming parallel ridges of varying widths (called jumbo, elephant, and needlecord) known as wales.

1918 ▷

CO-RESPONDENT SHOES Men’s shoes, usually *brogues*, made from two different colours of leather, such as tan and white.

1934 ▷: SEE PP.298, 303, 333, 340

CORNETTE The long tail of a hood; also a type of *wimple* of starched cloth, folded up into two “horns”.

MEDIEVAL

CORSAGE

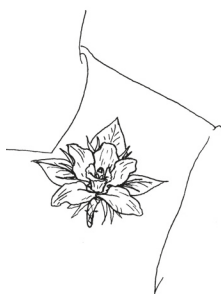
The *bodice* of a woman’s dress; also a bunch of flowers pinned to a woman’s bust or shoulder, or worn on the wrist.

19TH CENTURY ▷:

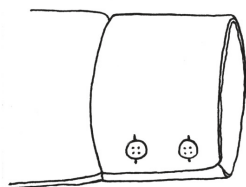
SEE PP.190, 205, 363

CORSET A supportive undergarment for women, comprising a sleeveless, boned *bodice* worn under clothing and covering bust to hips.

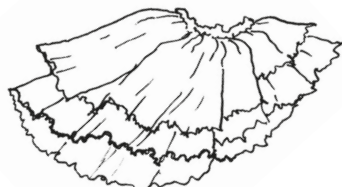
LATE 18TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.133, 190, 432–3



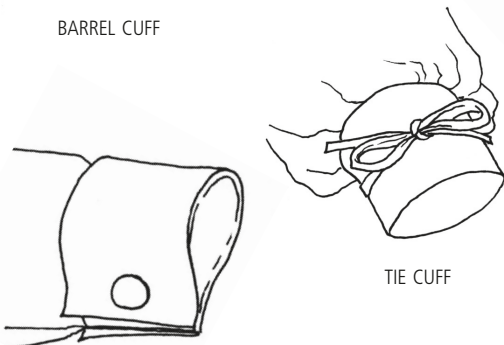
CUFFS



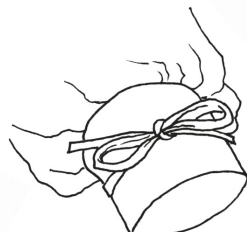
BARREL CUFF



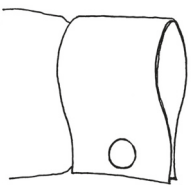
ENGAGEANTES



FRENCH CUFF



TIE CUFF



SINGLE CUFF

COSSACKS Men’s trousers with tapering legs, *pleated* at the waist, and with drawstrings at the ankle or straps under the instep.

1814–c.1850: SEE P.184

COSTUME An outfit worn for a specific event or for theatrical performance, or worn by a particular ethnic group; sometimes used for a woman’s outfit of *jacket* and *skirt*.

1800 ▷

COSTUME JEWELLERY Accessories made with inexpensive materials such as paste, glass, or *rhinestones* to imitate gems, or “base metal” coloured to resemble gold or silver.

1930s ▷

COTE Long garment worn over the *chemise* and under the *robe*, by both men and women.

14TH–15TH CENTURY: SEE PP.72–4

COTE-HARDIE A close-fitting, hip-length overgarment for men, or an overgarment for women with a close-fitting *bodice* and sleeves and a wide, full skirt.

14TH–15TH CENTURY: SEE PP.62–3

COTHURNUS An Ancient Greek boot worn for hunting, with thick soles and reaching to mid-calf; also used as part of costumes for Greek and Roman actors in tragedies.

ANTIQUITY

COTTAGE BONNET Simple, close-fitting straw *bonnet* with the sides projecting beyond the wearer’s face.

1808–1870

COTTON White, downy fibre from the bolls (seed capsules) of the cotton plant (genus *Gossypium*), and fabric woven from it; first used in the Americas and Asia, and one of the most widely used fabrics today.

5000BCE ▷

COUCHED WORK A decorative technique in which threads are laid on the surface of a fabric and then secured with small stitches of another thread.

11TH CENTURY ▷

COURT SHOES

Women’s shoes with a low vamp and a medium-high heel; see also *Pumps*.

20TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.273, 396, 426–7



COUTURE From the French for “sewing”, the creation of high-fashion, often custom-made, clothing for women; see also *Haute couture*.

COVERT COAT A short overcoat for men, with a fly front and vents in the side seams, originally for riding but later adopted generally.

1880s ▷

COWBOY BOOTS Sturdy riding boots, usually mid-calf height and with a *Cuban heel*, often with ornate embroidery on the side; originally worn by North American cowboys.

MID-19TH CENTURY ▷

COWBOY HAT Wide-brimmed hat with tall crown; made from *felt*, straw, or leather; first worn by working cowboys in the USA; John B. Stetson is credited with making the first.

MID-19TH CENTURY ▷ SEE P.434

COWBOY STYLE A casual style of dress based on the work clothes worn by US cowboys, such as *jeans*, *cowboy boots*, and *bandanas*.

1950s ▷

COWL NECK A large, softly draped collar seen on women’s jumpers and dresses.

1920s ▷: SEE PP.326, 451

CRAVAT A neckcloth for men, said to have originated in Croatia, today made from patterned fabric (usually *silk* or *wool*), with a *pleated* section to go around the neck.

LATE 17TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.136–7, 184–5

CRÊPE A thin, gauzy fabric in which the fibres are twisted before they are woven to give greater elasticity; types used today include *crêpe de chine* (*silk*) and *crêpe georgette* (*silk*, *rayon*, or *cotton*).

17TH CENTURY ▷